

Assessment Season Is Ending. Budget Season Starts Now.

About a 5 minute read

Gage County's 2026 values and protests are largely settled. The next decisions shaping final tax bills belong to local budgets and levies.

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ARTICLE TOOLS

ASSESSMENT SEASON

We made it through another assessment season

Protest hearings are complete, and the county board has finished its equalization work.

Some owners received the changes they asked for. Some received partial changes. Some properties remained as assessed, and some cases may continue to the Nebraska Tax Equalization and Review Commission. That range is fairly typical, but **every result matters to the owner involved**. *Before turning to budgets and levies*, it is worth looking at what this year's work accomplished—and at what the history of one real home can teach us.

By the measures that matter, we moved in the right direction

By the measures used to evaluate equalization, **Gage County moved in the right direction this year**. The overall relationship between residential assessments and the market improved. That does not mean the work is perfect or finished, but the completed revaluation left the residential roll in a better statistical position than it was a year ago.

Technical equalization detail

From 2025 to 2026, the residential median ratio moved from 94.45 to 96.44, the coefficient of dispersion improved from 24.42 to 17.03, and the price-related differential moved from 1.077 to 1.041. The PRD improved but remains just above the IAAO reference range of 0.98 to 1.03.

View Nebraska Property Assessment Division reports and opinions (<https://revenue.nebraska.gov/PAD/research-statistical-reports/reports-and-opinions>)

§ A note on Nebraska law

Nebraska real property is assessed each year as of January 1. Separately, state law requires a systematic inspection and review program that reaches every parcel at least once every six years. The six-year requirement is an inspection-and-review requirement, not a six-year assessment cycle.

Neb. Rev. Stat. § 77-1301 · Neb. Rev. Stat. § 77-1311.03

Those countywide measures tell us whether the roll moved in the right direction overall. Property owners, of course, experience that work *one home at a time*.

I recently saw a Beatrice homeowner raise a sincere concern about how much a home's value had changed since 2009. I'm always curious about people's stories and how assessments—and, more directly, property taxes—affect them. *So I went looking through the public history.*

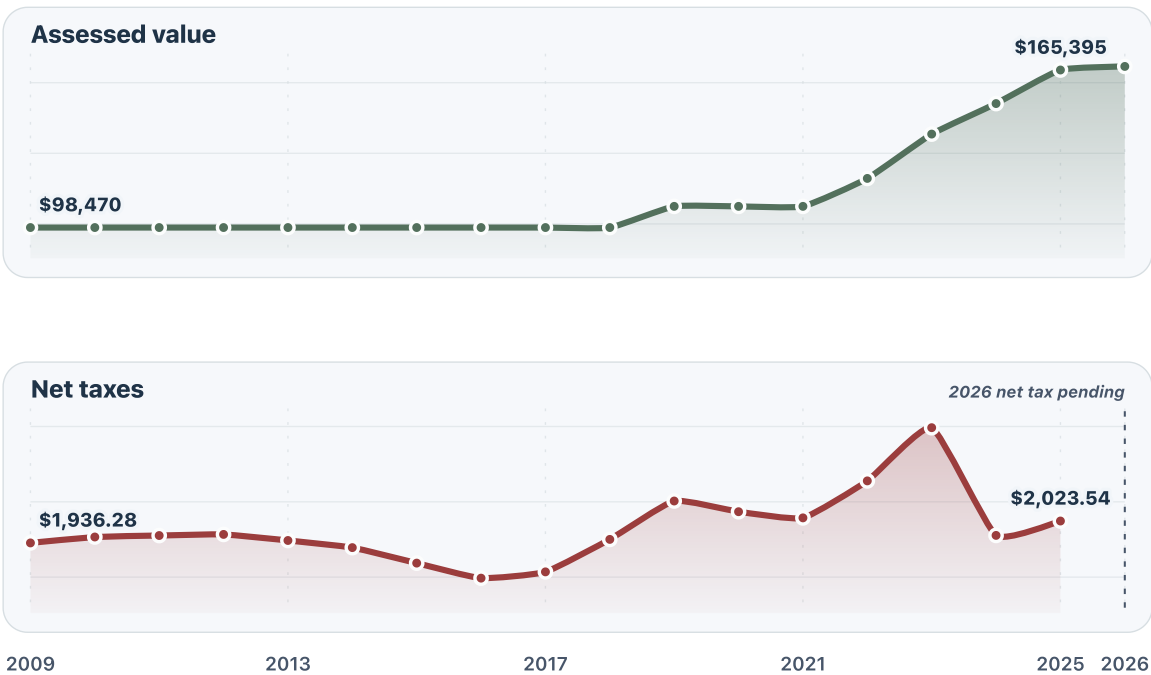
I removed the name, address, parcel number, and other identifying details because *the point is the history—not the homeowner.*

So I pulled the public record going back to 2009. Here is what it shows.

VERIFIED ANNUAL HISTORY

One Beatrice Home:
Assessed Value and Net Taxes Since 2009

Assessed value Net taxes



Annual assessed values and net taxes from aligned tax-year records, shown on two panels with a shared year axis.

Assessed value

2009

\$98,470



2025

\$165,395

Assessed value change

Percentage

+68.0%

Dollar change

+\$66,925

Net taxes

2009

\$1,936.28

→

2025

\$2,023.54

Net-tax change

Percentage

+4.5%

Dollar change

+\$87.26

2026: Assessed value is \$166,910. The levy and net tax have not yet been determined.

View the verified annual figures

Annual values, net taxes, and available total levies

Tax year	Assessed value	Net taxes	Total levy
2009	\$98,470	\$1,936.28	Not displayed
2010	\$98,470	\$1,959.92	Not displayed
2011	\$98,470	\$1,965.76	2.071625
2012	\$98,470	\$1,970.20	2.072314
2013	\$98,470	\$1,946.02	2.042235
2014	\$98,470	\$1,917.60	2.018927
2015	\$98,470	\$1,855.90	1.978838
2016	\$98,470	\$1,796.02	1.913488
2017	\$98,470	\$1,821.02	1.937257
2018	\$98,470	\$1,950.34	2.067146
2019	\$107,465	\$2,103.24	2.061282
2020	\$107,465	\$2,060.62	2.019692
2021	\$107,465	\$2,036.08	2.002198
2022	\$119,335	\$2,183.38	1.936215
2023	\$138,170	\$2,395.28	1.844862
2024	\$151,135	\$1,966.28	1.686636
2025	\$165,395	\$2,023.54	1.586964
2026	\$166,910	Not yet determined	Not displayed

Download the anonymous CSV dataset

SOURCE

Nebraska Taxes Online labels each statement by tax year.
The chart pairs the value and net tax printed on the same tax-year statement. Payment dates may fall in a later calendar year.

I don't want to use one home's history to dismiss what anyone else has experienced. **Every property is different, every tax district is different,** and an increase that looks manageable on paper may still matter a great deal within a household budget.

But this is a recognizable Beatrice example: an ordinary home listed in average condition, with no major addition or new construction identified in the current record. *It cannot tell us what happened everywhere.* It can help us see one important distinction clearly.

A percentage change in assessed value is not, by itself, a forecast of the percentage change in the final tax bill.

HOW THE BILL IS BUILT

How an assessment becomes a tax bill

Here is the important distinction: an assessment is one input in a property-tax bill. **It is not the bill itself.**

1 ASSESSMENT

Establishes taxable value and the property's relative share.

2 BUDGETS

Establish the revenue local public bodies request.

3 LEVIES

Apply those revenue needs across the taxable value in each district.

4 FINAL TAX BILL

Combines the levies for the property's county, city or village, school, and other applicable districts.

Exemptions and credits can change what an individual owner ultimately pays.

That is why a larger valuation base can allow a levy to fall when budget needs do not grow at the same pace. **It can—but it does not guarantee that it will.**

That explains how assessments and tax bills can move differently. It leaves another question: now that the countywide revaluation is complete, what might the market require next?

The revaluation crossed an unusually turbulent period

The revaluation crossed a volatile post-pandemic sales period. Nationally, very low mortgage rates and strong demand accompanied rapid housing activity and price movement. Higher rates later restrained activity, and the Federal Reserve reported in July 2026 that existing-home sales had been moving sideways at relatively low levels for several years. That is national context, not a Gage County forecast.

SOURCE

Federal Reserve Monetary Policy Report, July 2026

Used for national housing-activity and mortgage-rate context only; it is not treated as a forecast for Gage County assessments.

MY OPINION—NOT A FORECAST

This is my opinion: Higher borrowing costs appear to be keeping the market from moving at the pace we saw several years ago. *If that continues*, I think Gage County may be positioned for a more ordinary assessment cycle next year—one driven by sales in particular locations and property groups rather than another broad countywide reset.

That does not mean values will be flat, and it is not a promise about any individual property. It is simply my reading of where the market appears to be today.

Whatever the market does next, the 2026 values are now largely set. **The decisions still ahead this year belong to budgets, property-tax requests, and levies.**

THE NEXT PUBLIC DECISIONS

Budgets, hearings, and levies come next

The next decisions belong to the county, cities, schools, and other subdivisions serving each tax district. Here are the principal dates ahead.

Sept. 14–23 Joint public-hearing window when the statutory trigger applies	Sept. 30 Budget filing deadline	Oct. 15 Property-tax request information due to county officials	Oct. 20 County board levy-setting deadline
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BUDGET REVIEW

What I'll be watching

How much is changing?

Compare each subdivision's proposed budget and property-tax request with last year.

Is it temporary or ongoing?

Separate one-time projects from costs that will continue in future budgets.

Is the request outpacing the tax base?

Compare requested property-tax growth with growth in taxable value.

As the proposed budgets become public and the figures can be verified, I'll continue working through what they may mean for property owners. I'll also return to this home when the final levy and tax figures are available to see how the next part of its history turned out.

SOURCE

Nebraska Department of Revenue Property Assessment Division main calendar

The posted calendar is labeled for 2025 but was revised in June 2026 and includes the 2026 deadlines cited here.

Those are the general questions. Here in Gage County, several specific needs are already part of the conversation.

A few local decisions remain unsettled

Beatrice's street plan keeps road and infrastructure needs in the budget conversation. **The county's law-enforcement center remains a proposal, and its financing has not been settled**; possible approaches include a voter-approved bond or legislative authority for a targeted sales tax. School budgets will remain a major part of many local tax bills, but I have not found a sufficiently concrete new Beatrice school bond or facility proposal to include here.



Final law-enforcement center town hall

Southeast Community College

AEC Building, Room 134

4771 West Scott Road, Beatrice, Nebraska

Monday, August 10, 2026

7:00 p.m.

[assets/calendar/gage-law-enforcement-center-town-hall-2026-08-10.ics](#)

The final public town hall on the proposed Gage County Sheriff's Office Law Enforcement Center.

Those budget and financing decisions will play out over the coming months. At the same time, **the assessment calendar does not stop.**

LOOKING TOWARD 2027

Less like a reset, more like annual maintenance

Annual assessment work does not stop when a countywide revaluation ends. The 2027 assessment date arrives January 1. Sales will still be reviewed, records will still be maintained, and market evidence may still require adjustments.

With the countywide revaluation complete, the next few years may feel less like a major reset and more like routine annual maintenance—*provided the market remains reasonably steady*. Not necessarily flat, and never automatic. **But hopefully less turbulent.**

REFERENCE

Sources and further reading

Official records supporting the data, law, calendar, market context, and local matters discussed above.

ASSESSMENT AND TAX EVIDENCE

TAX RECORD

Anonymous historical dataset

Verified 2009-2026 assessed values, 2009-2025 net taxes, available levies, and record-status notes.

[data/articles/one-beatrice-home-assessment-tax-history.csv](#)

TAX RECORD

Nebraska Taxes Online

Official annual tax-statement history used for the anonymous home's 2009-2025 values, net taxes, and available levy totals.

<https://nebraskataxesonline.us/>

PAD REPORT

2026 Gage County PAD Report and Opinion statistics

Countywide valuation growth, level-of-value, and assessment-quality statistics used to describe the completed revaluation.

<https://revenue.nebraska.gov/PAD/research-statistical-reports/reports-and-opinions>

LAW AND CALENDAR

ASSESSMENT GUIDANCE

Nebraska property assessment calendar

Revised June 2026; includes 2026 budget, hearing, filing, appeal, and levy dates.

<https://revenue.nebraska.gov/sites/default/files/doc/pad/calendar/PAD%20MAIN%20CALENDAR%20for%202025.pdf>

LEGAL AUTHORITY

Neb. Rev. Stat. 77-1301

Annual January 1 assessment date and annual completion duty.

<https://nebraskalegislature.gov/laws/statutes.php?statute=77-1301>

LEGAL AUTHORITY

Neb. Rev. Stat. 77-1311.03

Systematic inspection and review, including the no-less-frequently-than-six-years requirement.

<https://nebraskalegislature.gov/laws/statutes.php?statute=77-1311.03>

LEGAL AUTHORITY

Neb. Rev. Stat. 77-1601

County board levy-setting deadline and authority.

<https://nebraskalegislature.gov/laws/statutes.php?statute=77-1601>

LOCAL DECISIONS TO FOLLOW

OFFICIAL RESOURCE

Gage County public meetings

Agendas, minutes, and audio for county board, equalization, and protest meetings.

<https://gagecountyne.gov/county-board/board-meetings/>

OFFICIAL RESOURCE

City of Beatrice operating budget

Adopted biennial budget and annual public-hearing information.

<https://www.beatrice.ne.gov/governance-administration/budget-and-finances/operating-budget/>

OFFICIAL RESOURCE

City of Beatrice one- and six-year street plan

Adopted street-improvement plan used to characterize infrastructure needs without assuming a tax outcome.

<https://www.beatrice.ne.gov/media/37881>

OFFICIAL RESOURCE**Gage County law-enforcement center information**

Current project review and explicitly preliminary funding approaches.

<https://gagecountysheriff.us/general-information/>

MARKET CONTEXT

OFFICIAL RESOURCE**Federal Reserve Monetary Policy Report, July 2026**

National housing-activity and mortgage-rate context; not a forecast of Gage County values.

<https://www.federalreserve.gov/monetarypolicy/2026-07-mpr-part1.htm>

COMPANION ARTICLES

COMPANION GUIDE**How Your Property Value Becomes a Tax Bill**

A deeper walk through the assessment, protest, budget, levy, and tax-bill sequence.

<articles/how-your-property-value-becomes-a-tax-bill/>

COMPANION GUIDE**Watch the Tax Roll Move**

An interactive explanation of relative value movement, budgets, and levy compression.

<articles/watch-the-tax-roll-move/>
